JOB SEARCH / START WITH THE RECORD

Set up your job search tracking.

Keep one record per opening, with enough context to answer three questions.

Where does it stand?

Use a stage such as Leads, Tailoring or Applied to describe progress. Record the latest confirmed change.

What do I need to do?

Write down your next step and any deadline or reminder. If you're waiting for a response, note who you're waiting on.

What will I need?

Keep the posting, exact submitted materials and relevant conversation with the record.

The same stage can need different attention

Applied	Waiting for an employer response → No action right now
Applied	Recruiter asks for availability → Reply by the requested date

Choose one active opening and make its next step clear. You can build the rest around that.

01 / KEEP THE CORE SMALL

Make the useful part easy to find.

Keep the opening, stage, next action and date visible. Put supporting detail in the same record or link it from there.

Identify the opening

Company, role, application link and job ID when available. Keep a copy of the job description so it survives a closed posting.

Describe the next step

Write a specific action, who owes it, and a date only when useful. Specify whether the date is an external deadline or your own reminder. Add the contact or thread once a conversation starts.

Preserve what you submitted

Record the submission date and confirmation status. Attach the exact résumé sent, or link to the saved file. Keep the cover letter and answers too, when relevant. A missing receipt does not mean submission failed.

Add a field when it helps a decision: pay, location, working pattern or an open question. If you never use it to choose, act or understand what happened, leave it out.

Keep current information easy to scan. Put dated updates in comments or a short history beneath it.

02 / CHOOSE THE VIEW YOU NEED

Use a tool that suits the work.

Start with what you already use. Choose the form that makes your active applications easiest to review.

Notes and a calendar

Useful for a few active roles. Keep one note per opening, with links and the next action. Put timed steps or chosen reminders in your calendar. Review the notes as the list grows.

Light setup; comparing several openings takes more scanning.

A spreadsheet

Useful when you want to compare openings side by side. Give each role one row; keep stage, next action and date near the front. Link to saved job descriptions and submitted files.

Easy comparison; long notes and files need a clear place to live.

A board

Useful when you want to see roles grouped by stage. Give each opening one card. Keep the next action and materials inside it, and open active cards when reviewing.

Visible stages; next actions may require opening the cards.

If your current setup answers the three questions, keep it. Improve one record before moving everything to a new tool.

03 / MAKE UPKEEP PART OF THE SEARCH

Update at the moments that matter.

A short routine keeps the record useful. Use this as a starting point and adjust it to your workload.

After a submission or response

Record what happened, the date and its source. Update the stage if it changed. Replace the next action and its date; retain the earlier update in comments or history.

At the start of a search session

Open your active records. Check the next action and relevant dates, then choose what to work on. Return to the saved materials before a reply, application or interview.

Try a weekly sweep

Reconcile missed updates, clear obsolete reminders and record known outcomes. Check whether any fields have become maintenance work without helping a decision. Review more or less often as needed.

When you finish an action, decide what comes next. Clear the old date if nothing does. An active application can stay open while you wait.

Age alone does not create a follow-up. Use a nudge when there is a conversation to continue or an agreed next step.

04 / PUT ONE RECORD TO WORK

Keep the context. Change the next action.

Fictional example: Riverton / Office Coordinator. A scheduling request changes the action while the application stays Applied.

After applying

Next step: Waiting for a response

Stage: Applied | Waiting on: Employer

Date: No date

Submission and confirmation recorded; job description saved; exact résumé attached or linked.

After a scheduling request

Next step: Send available times

Stage: Applied | Waiting on: Me

Date: 29 October, the requested reply date

Add the request to the history. After replying, record it and replace or clear the date.

Rejected/Closed	Employer rejection or a confirmed end to the hiring process.
Not pursued	Your decision to stop, including withdrawal, or an opening that expired before you applied. Retain any submission history.
Offer	Keep an accepted offer here until outstanding actions are resolved. Then mark the record complete.

Record the reason before closing a record. Silence or a disappearing posting alone does not establish an outcome.

Start with one current application. Make its next step clear, keep the material with it, and add other active roles as needed.

OPTIONAL / AI SUPPORT

Turn messages into tracker updates.

Give AI your current tracker entries and new emails or notes. It can help identify what changed and pull together your upcoming actions.

Copy this prompt

Help me update my job-search tracker. Today's date is [date]. Use the entries and dated messages or notes I provide. Match each update to the company, role and job ID, when available; ask if the match is unclear. Show the proposed changes to the stage, next action, who is responsible and any date, with the message or note supporting each change. Clear completed actions and their old dates. Keep employer deadlines separate from my own reminders. Preserve application history and submitted files. List upcoming actions by date and flag missing or conflicting details. Don’t invent outcomes, dates or follow-ups based only on how long an application has been open. Propose changes for me to review and apply.

Have it check for you

If your AI tool supports scheduled tasks and connected email, you can repeat this check automatically. Availability and cost depend on the tool and plan.

Choose the schedule, time zone and application emails to check. Compare messages since the last successful check with the existing tracker. Test one run before enabling the schedule.

Keep the prompt’s review step, or replace it with specific updates you authorize if the tool can edit your tracker. For example: log receipts and confirmed interview dates; flag unclear matches or conflicting details. Request notifications for actions you need to take or failed checks.

Asana starter, setup instructions and read-only example:
martaavilesmontalvo.github.io/job-search-starter/tracking.html